Columbus Public Health • Food Protection Program

Food Facility Plan Review Introduction

All retail food businesses in the City of Columbus and Worthington must have a Food Service Operation (FSO) or Retail Food Establishment (RFE) license issued by Columbus Public Health (CPH). Please call ahead for office visits to make sure someone is available to help you.

See the CPH "Starting a Food Business" for more detailed information. It is strongly recommended that you read this guide before submitting your plans. Read it here: https://www.columbus.gov/Services/Food-Protection-Program.

Contact CPH about plan approval or licensing if you are going to:

- Open a restaurant or retail food facility.
- Remodel a facility.
- Change ownership or your license status, including changes to menu, equipment or processes.

Plan Review Process

All new food businesses, ones performing extensive alterations, or businesses changing ownership must complete the plan review process. To obtain a food service license from Columbus Public Health, you must:

Step 1: Submit Plans (at least 45 days prior to estimated opening date) to EH@columbus.gov, including:

- Plan review fee (included later in this document).
- One complete set of drawings of the facility.
- Completed application (this document).
- Menu or list of food and drink items to be sold.

Step 2: Plans are Reviewed

- CPH will review the plans within 30 days of receipt of payment.
- Plans may need more information or changes. In this case, you will be contacted.

Step 3: Plans are Approved

- We will send an email when the plans have been approved.
- Plan approvals expire in one year, unless the facility is under construction.

Step 4: Construction Begins

- All contractors and sub-contractors need to be licensed, if necessary. (Check with City of Columbus Building Services at 614-645-7314.)
- Contractors must obtain necessary permits through Building Services.
- Contact CPH if you need a walk-through inspection during construction.

Step 5: Invoice Created and Licensing Inspection Scheduled

- CPH will use this application to create a profile and invoice. This information is required to schedule the inspection.

Step 6: Final Inspection for Food License

- Get signatures ('sign offs') from all building inspections, then contact CPH for an opening inspection. Arrange for this inspection once approval for a Certificate of Occupancy (or Partial Certificate of Occupancy, if applicable) has been given.
- CPH requires two business days' notice to schedule an inspection. Call early to avoid scheduling conflicts and allow time for re-inspection if necessary. Call 614-645-7005 to schedule the inspection.
- Once the appropriate license fee is paid and the opening inspection is completed by CPH, you will be able to open for business.

Equipment Requirements in Facilities

Hand Washing Sinks
The number of required handwashing sinks is determined by evaluating the facility layout and food handling locations. Each hand washing sink is required to have warm water (85° F), soap, an approved method to dry hands, and signage. A hand washing sink in a restroom will not fulfill hand sink requirements. A hand washing sink is required in all of the following locations:

- Food prep area.
- Dish washing area.
- Bar.
- Service station.

Mop Sinks
All facilities are required to have a sink designated only for the cleaning of mops, tools and disposal of mop water. The mop sink must include a faucet and drain and be used for no other purposes. Mop sinks must be located on each floor with a food preparation area. Additional mop sinks may be required, depending on size and layout of the facility.

Three-Compartment Sinks
The facility must have a three-compartment sink designated for dishwashing in any operation using dishes or utensils. All child care centers and bar/bar-style service areas require a three-compartment sink, even if using all disposable items. The sink shall have smooth interior edges and at least three compartments for washing, rinsing and sanitizing. The sink also must have two drain boards, one for collection of dirty dishes and the other for air drying. Each compartment of the sink must be large enough to submerge the largest piece of equipment at least halfway. Grease interceptors are not determined by our department. Please contact greaseinterceptor@columbus.gov.

Dump Sinks
All bar and beverage preparation areas are required to have a dump sink. If applicable, a four-compartment sink can be used as a dump sink/dishwashing sink.

Food Preparation Sinks
A food preparation sink is required for:

- Washing fruits, vegetables or other foods.
- Soaking fruits, vegetables or other foods.
- Thawing frozen foods under running water.
- Cooling hot food items in an ice bath.

A food preparation sink must have an indirect drain (air gap) to prevent backflow from a sewage system into equipment in which food is placed. If a food preparation sink is not available, the facility will be limited to using only pre-washed produce.

Commercial Equipment
The Ohio Uniform Food Code requires facilities to use only certified commercial-grade equipment from recognized testing agencies.

- Accepted certifications are: NSF, UL EPH, ETL Sanitation, CSA Sanitation.
- No household equipment is permitted.

To schedule a walk-through of your facility or if you have questions, call 614-645-7005.

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Food Facility Plan Review Application

Must include EIN number and proof of ownership. Proof of ownership includes (one):

- Internal Revenue Service (IRS) SS-4 EIN confirmation letter.
- Letter from your bank, specifying the entity has an active account.
- Check with your entity name and address listed.
- Copy of a local or state license connected to the entity (e.g., liquor or vendor's license with same owner).
- Redacted tax return filed with the IRS (cover page only listing the year, entity name and EIN).
- IRS 501(C)(3) tax exemption confirmation letter (if applicable).

Facility Information

Name of Facility:_____

Address: _____

City: _____ State: _____ ZIP: _____

Email: _____ Phone: _____

Ownership Information

Ownership Entity Name: _____

Email: _____ Phone: _____

Send payment invoice to this email: ☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

Mailing Address (if different than facility address): _____

City: _____ State: _____ ZIP: _____

Ownership EIN#: _____

Contact Person for Plans

Name: _____

Email: _____ Phone: _____

Send payment invoice to this email: ☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

Plan Review Type

- ☐ New Establishment (8021)
- ☐ Full Remodel (torn down and rebuilt, full inside demo) (8021)
- ☐ Remodel/Alteration of Existing Food Establishment (8025)
- ☐ Change of Ownership (8036)

For remodel, briefly describe project details: _____

Estimated date construction begins: _____ Estimated opening date: _____

INTERNAL USE ONLY

Date received: _____ Received by: _____ SR#: _____

Amount paid:_____ AR#: _____ IN#: _____ PE Code: _____

THE CITY OF COLUMBUS
ANDREW J. GINTHER, MAYOR
COLUMBUS PUBLIC HEALTH

Questions? Email EH@columbus.gov or call 614-645-7005.

Type of Establishment & Details *(Check all that apply.)*

- ☐ Restaurant or Diner
- ☐ Bakery
- ☐ Meat/Fish Market
- ☐ Caterer
- ☐ Convenience Store
- ☐ Diner/Cafe
- ☐ Child Care facility
- ☐ Pizza Shop
- ☐ Long Term Care
- ☐ Coffee Shop
- ☐ School
- ☐ Bar
- ☐ Grocery Store
- ☐ Other (please specify): _____

Square Feet Inside Food Establishment: _____

Water Supply: ☐ City ☐ Onsite Well/Other (please specify): _____

Sewage Disposal: ☐ Sanitary Sewer ☐ Onsite Wastewater Treatment System

If system is semi-public, is it approved by OEPA? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Food Handling Process

Answer all questions that apply to your facility.

Will fruits and vegetables be washed in the establishment? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable

Will you do any of the following? (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Sushi
- ☐ Cooling food
- ☐ Reheating food in bulk
- ☐ Smoking or curing
- ☐ Reduced-oxygen packaging
- ☐ Serve highly susceptible population
- ☐ Serve raw or undercooked menu items
- ☐ Catering (this is not delivery only services)

Do you plan to prepare foods off site? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, describe: _____

_____

_____

_____

Plan Review Components

The plans submitted to CPH must be easy to read and include the following information. If not, it may delay plan approval and/or the opening of your business. All items in bold are required for every new facility.

Please indicate that the following are included (check box) or indicate if not applicable (N/A).

- ☐ **Site plan**
  - ☐ Shows designated area for garbage, grease dumpsters, outside storage areas.
  - ☐ Shows the location of the building and surrounding streets.
- ☐ **Proposed menu or list of food and beverage items. (*All facilities must submit.)**
- ☐ **Facility floor plan, drawn to scale, to include location of:**
  - ☐ Dry goods, chemical and personal belongings storage.
  - ☐ Entrances and exits.
  - ☐ Hand sinks available in food prep areas and restrooms.
  - ☐ Three-compartment dish washing sink.
  - ☐ Dish machine (indicate high or low temperature).
  - ☐ Food preparation/vegetable washing sink (must have indirect drain).
  - ☐ Utility sink/mop sink.
  - ☐ Equipment.
- ☐ **Equipment list, including make and model numbers. (*Commercial equipment only.)**
  - ☐ Include how equipment will be elevated or installed so facility can be easily cleaned (e.g., casters, legs, fixed/sealed).
- ☐ **Basic plumbing drawings, including the following:**
  - ☐ Show grease trap location.
  - ☐ Show all indirect plumbing connections and floor drains and sinks.
- ☐ **Interior finish schedule** with materials for floors, walls, ceilings and coving. (Example included.)
- ☐ **Lighting plan** (include type of fixtures and location of lights).
- ☐ **Ventilation hoods**
  - ☐ ANSI approved fire suppression systems over grease producing equipment.

Interior Finishes

All floors, walls and ceilings in food areas must be smooth and easily cleanable as defined in OAC §3717-1-06(A). Carpet is acceptable only in areas for packaged food storage. Acceptable surfaces which are commonly used include:

- Floors: quarry tile, ceramic tile, sealed concrete, poured epoxy.
- Walls: stainless steel (required behind cooking equipment), fiber-reinforced plastic (FRP), glossy painted drywall, painted concrete block.
- Ceilings: vinyl coated acoustic ceiling tile (drop ceiling), glossy painted drywall.
- Base Coving: tile, rubber.

Use the following chart to show all interior finishes or materials (unless already included in plans).
☐ This information is included in plans submitted.

Room Name	Floors	Wall	Ceilings	Coving
Example: Kitchen	*Quarry tile*	*FRP*	*Vinyl acoustic tile*	*6" quarry tile*

Plan Review & License Fees

The plan review fee must be submitted with application. If you wish to pay online, check the appropriate box and an invoice will be emailed with instructions. Please make checks payable to the Columbus City Treasurer.

PLAN REVIEW FEES	<25,000 ft^2	>25,000 ft^2
Risk Level 1-4	$440	$1,150
Expedited Plan Review	$1,400 + plan review fee	

The license fee will be collected at the final inspection. Please do not send it to our office.

LICENSE FEES	Commercial		Non-Commercial	
	<25,000 ft^2	>25,000 ft^2	<25,000 ft^2	>25,000 ft^2
Risk Level 1	$322	$433	$161	$216.50
Risk Level 2	$353	$452	$176.50	$226
Risk Level 3	$611	$1,420	$305.50	$710
Risk Level 4	$755	$1,502	$377.50	$751

Plan Review Submission & Signature

To the best of my knowledge, this application is complete and accurate. Facilities that remodel or change ownership through the plan review process must bring the facility up to current standards. I understand that incomplete plans may delay the plan approval process. I have carefully read the entire application. I am submitting a set of plans, a menu and the plan review fee. I understand it may take up to 30 days for review. A separate license fee will be collected at the final inspection.

Signature of applicant: _____ Date: _____

Submit plans to EH@columbus.gov (use guidelines below).

Submit Plans via Email

Email your completed plan review application and files to EH@columbus.gov. You will receive an emailed invoice within two business days. If you do not receive an invoice within two days, please contact us immediately.

- **Submit as a PDF:** Each set of plans must be saved in PDF format and should be oriented so the document can be viewed without rotation. Electronic "bookmarks" in the PDF are helpful and encouraged.
- **Necessary Pages Only:** Please provide only those pages that are necessary for the public health review.
- **Full Size and To-Scale:** Plans must be saved at 'full size' and 'to-scale' to ensure proper measurement of lines and areas electronically.
- **Additional Files:** Supplemental files such as menus and equipment specification sheets should be named with a unique and descriptive file name (for example, menu, floor plan, plumbing plan, equipment list).
- **No ZIP Files or Cloud Links:** Please do not send ZIP files or links as they cannot be opened.
- **Completed Plan Review Application:** A complete plan review application must be included.
- **Email Subject:** Subject line of email should include address of the facility.